JACOBY TRANSFERS

ABOUT THE DEALS

You may be either Opener or Responder, but you will always be in the South position.

Feel free to disagree with some of the bids that do not apply directly to Transfers. Deals 9 and 21 for example.

Although it is not included in the Deals you might wish to examine your and dummy's hand and make a Plan of how you would play the contract.

JACOBY TRANSFERS SUMMARY

Created by Oswald Jacoby a lot of years ago, there are two good reasons to use Transfers.

1. They provide a precise bidding method when the Responder to a 1NT opening has a 5 or 6 card Major suit.
2. They make the opening 1NT hand the declarer, keeping the stronger hand concealed.

Jacoby Transfers should only be used in conjunction with the Stayman Convention. The two work smoothly together with Stayman taking care of those hands where Responder has a 4-card Major(s) and Jacoby Transfers taking care of those hands where Responder has a 5- or 6-card Major.

The actual working of transfer bids is simple:
After a 1NT opening a 2♦ response requires Opener to bid 2♥, while a 2♥ response requires Opener to bid 2♠.
On his next bid Responder clarifies the picture by either placing the contract or by inviting Opener to do so.

Jacoby Transfers take much of the guesswork (sometimes called judgement) out of the bidding and steer you directly to these two goals:

1. With a partnership 26 points you will reach game, with 33 you will reach slam.
2. With a partnership 8+ cards in a Major suit you will play in that suit, otherwise you will play notrump.

For the first point consider this table which is based on the 1NT opener holding 15-17 points.

Resp Points	Opener Points			Bidding Target
	15	16	17	
8	23	24	25	Partscore
9	24	25	26	
10	25	26	27	
11	26	27	28	
12	27	28	29	Game
13	28	29	30	
14	29	30	31	
15	30	31	32	
16	31	32	33	
17	32	33	34	Slam
18	33	34	35	

Responder's actions are as follows:

- 8 points or fewer - either pass or transfer and then pass
- 9 points - invite partner to game
- 10 points - either invite or force to game, using your judgement
- 11-15 points - force to game
- 16 points - invite to slam
- 17 points - either invite or force to slam, using your judgement
- 18 points or more - force to slam

Opener's actions are as follows:

- 15 points - decline invitations
- 16 points - either decline or accept, using your judgement
- 17 points - accept invitations

As to the second point above (the 8-card trump fit) you must keep in mind that it is correct to open 1NT with 5-3-3-2 distribution, so it is possible for Opener to have a doubleton in the Major suit that Responder is interested in. Therefore Responder must bid differently with a 5-card suit than he does with a 6-card suit.

- With a 5-card Major Responder transfers Opener to that Major suit, then at his next turn bids notrump.
- With a 6-card Major Responder transfers Opener to that Major suit, then at his next turn rebids the suit.

Opener also has to keep on the right track when Responder has shown only 5 of the suit by rebidding notrump.

- With 2 cards in the transferred suit Opener stays with notrump.
- With 3+ cards in the transferred suit Opener returns to the Major suit.

Some comments are in order about the point count methods used on these pages.

- Initial point count for both hands is based on 4-3-2-1 plus one point for a fifth card in a suit.
- Revalued points (only after a trump fit is discovered) are +1 for a doubleton held by Opener.

- Responder must be very cautious about adding short-suit revalued points. As the long-trump hand Responder will not be able to gain a trick by ruffing since it usually uses a trump which would be a winner anyway.

25 examples will be worth more than another 1000 words.

Board: 1
Dealer: **South**

Contract: 4♠
Declarer: North
Lead: ♦J

Board: 2
Dealer: **West**

Contract: 4♥
Declarer: East
Lead: ♠10

Board: 3
Dealer: **South**

Contract: 3NT
Declarer: South
Lead: ♥9

Board: 4
Dealer: **West**

Contract: 6NT
Declarer: West
Lead: ♣8

Board: 5
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♥
Declarer: North
Lead: ♥10

Board 1
South Deals
None Vul

	♠ K 10 9 8 7 ♥ A 9 7 6 4 ♦ 8 3 ♣ 5	
♠ 4 3 ♥ Q J 10 5 ♦ K Q 7 5 4 ♣ J 10		♠ A 6 2 ♥ 3 2 ♦ J 9 ♣ Q 7 6 4 3 2
	♠ Q J 5 ♥ K 8 ♦ A 10 6 2 ♣ A K 9 8	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1NT
Pass	2♦	Pass	2♥
Pass	2♠	Pass	4♠
All Pass			

4♠ by North
Lead: ♦J

South opens 1NT.

You transfer of course, but to which Major? It can work either way, but the preferred method is to first transfer partner to ♥s when you have an invitational hand. So you bid 2♦, and partner of course says 2♥.

You now show your second 5-card Major by bidding 2♠.

At this point partner becomes the Captain. You have described an invitational (9 point) hand with 5-5 in the Majors. Partner's next bid should set the contract wherever he chooses. In this case, with a maximum 1NT opener and 3 ♠s he picks 4♠.

Note that you must have at least one Major suit fit since partner cannot have a doubleton in both.

Board 2
West Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ K 7 3 2 ♥ 9 6 ♦ Q 10 4 ♣ A J 4 2	
♠ Q 6 ♥ A 7 4 ♦ K J 9 2 ♣ K Q 8 3		♠ A J 8 5 4 ♥ K Q 10 8 3 ♦ 6 ♣ 7 5
	♠ 10 9 ♥ J 5 2 ♦ A 8 7 5 3 ♣ 10 9 6	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
1NT	Pass	2♥	Pass
2♠	Pass	3♥	Pass
4♥			
All Pass			

4♥ by East
Lead: ♠10

West opens 1NT.

This is the sequel to Deal 6. You are 5-5 in the Majors again, but this time you have game forcing strength.

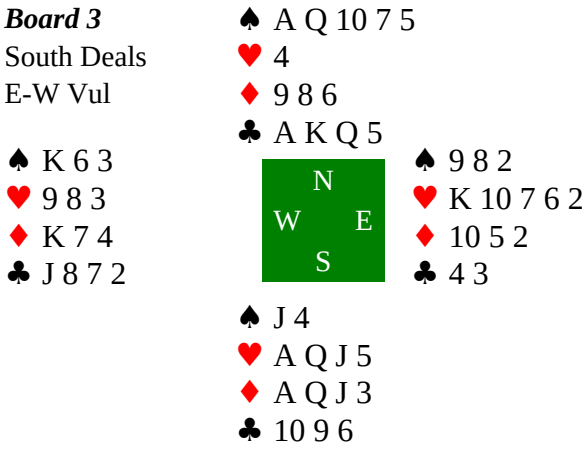
The preferred method for this hand is to transfer partner to ♠s, so you bid 2♥.

What do you bid after partner completes the transfer?

You show your second 5-card Major by bidding 3♥. Since this shows game-forcing strength (11+ points) partner may not pass, but must bid either 4♥ or 4♠. In this Deal he naturally bids 4♥.

If you held an even stronger hand and wished to move toward a slam you would start out the same way but then bid again after partner's game bid.

Board 3
South Deals
E-W Vul



West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1NT
Pass	2♥	Pass	2♠
Pass	3♣	Pass	3NT
All Pass			

3NT by South
Lead: ♥9

South opens 1NT.

Initiate the transfer by bidding 2♥. After partner responds 2♠

Your bid of a minor suit here shows at least 4 cards and is a slam try. With a weaker hand you would probably just bid 2NT or 3NT.

Having made the try, you accept whatever partner decides. In this case, with a 15 point minimum, a doubleton ♠ and no ♣ fit, partner settles on 3NT.

Board 4
West Deals
Both Vul

	♠ 6 3 ♥ 8 7 6 5 3 2 ♦ A J 5 ♣ 8 3	
♠ K J ♥ K Q 9 ♦ K 10 7 3 ♣ A J 7 4		♠ A Q 10 7 5 ♥ A 4 ♦ 9 8 6 ♣ K Q 5
	♠ 9 8 4 2 ♥ J 10 ♦ Q 4 2 ♣ 10 9 6 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
1NT	Pass	2♥	Pass
2♠	Pass	4NT	Pass
6NT			
All Pass			

6NT by West
Lead: ♣8

Here both partners understood the bid and West bid 6NT.

West opens 1NT.

With 16 points you have to be thinking about slam. But first things first, start the transfer process by bidding 2♥.

What is your next bid after partner's 2♠?

With 16 points you want to make an invitation to slam, but you also need to let partner know that you only have 5 ♠s so that he can play notrump when he only has a doubleton ♠.

The **BEST** way to say both these things is to bid 4NT. This is similar to the 2NT bid in Deal 2.

But you can see the problem with the bid - if partner mistakes it for Blackwood 4NT things could get very confused. So don't use this unless you know both of you are on the same wavelength.

Board 5
North Deals
None Vul

	♠ Q 2 ♥ A J 3 ♦ A K 6 4 ♣ K Q J 10	
♠ A 10 8 6 4 3 ♥ 2 ♦ J 8 7 ♣ 9 5 2		♠ K J 9 ♥ 10 9 6 5 ♦ Q 5 2 ♣ A 6 3
	♠ 7 5 ♥ K Q 8 7 4 ♦ 10 9 3 ♣ 8 7 4	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	2NT	Pass	3♦
Pass	3♥	Pass	3NT
Pass	4♥		
All Pass			

4♥ by North
Lead: ♥10

North opens 2NT showing a balanced 20-21 point hand.

Jacoby Transfers work fine with 2NT openings also. You should bid 3♦ as a transfer to ♥s. Partner complies by saying 3♥.

You bid 3NT which tells partner you have just 5 ♥s and lets him decide on which game to play.

On this Deal partner has 3 ♥s so he bids on to 4♥.

Notice that when partner opens 2NT the invitation to game option is no longer available. As responder you must decide immediately whether to stop short of game (by transferring then passing) or to go to game. This is not a serious problem since the tighter (20-21) point range makes responder's decision easier to make.